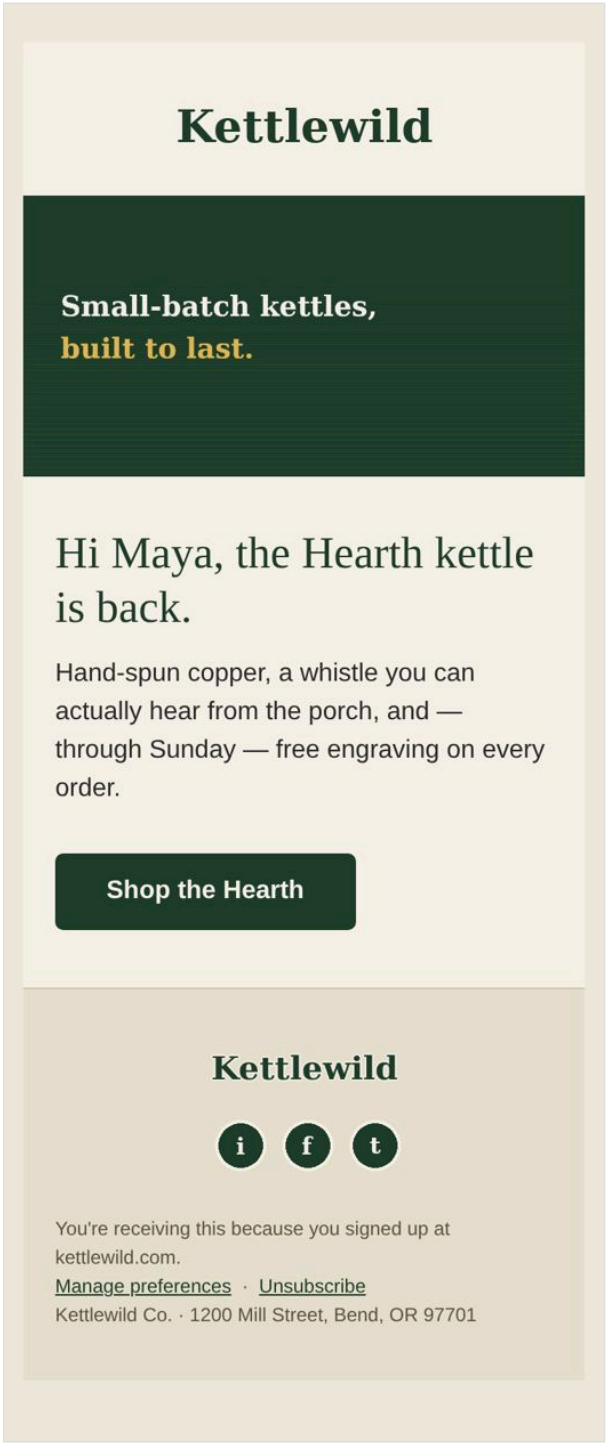
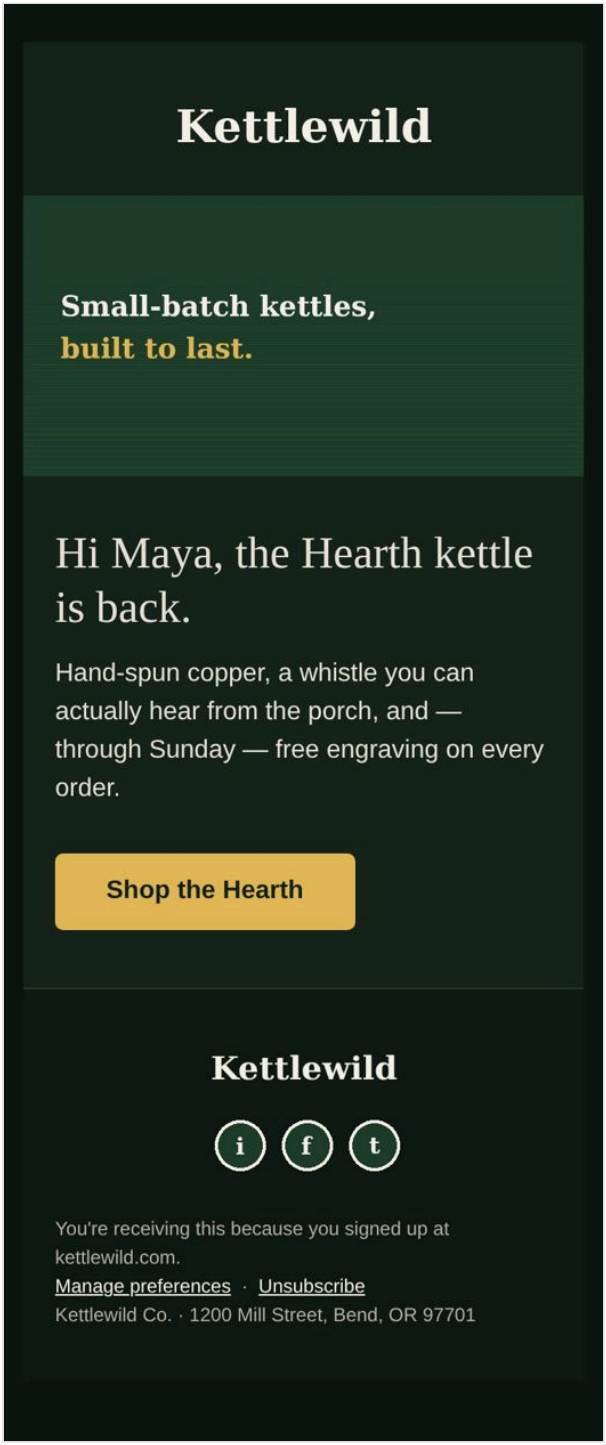
Dark-mode-safe Klaviyo footer: work sample

Emmanuel Marquez · HTML Email Developer · Concept build for a fictional brand, made for this proposal.

Light mode (mobile, 375px)



Dark mode: Apple Mail / iOS Mail behaviour (prefers-color-scheme)



How the footer is protected in each dark-mode engine

1. **Apple Mail / iOS Mail, Outlook for Mac:** `color-scheme` + `supported-color-schemes` meta opt in, then an `@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark)` palette on the footer background, text and links. The logo swaps from dark ink to cream ink, so it's never dark-on-dark.
2. **Outlook.com / Outlook apps:** `[data-ogsc]` / `[data-ogsb]` overrides, because those clients recolor text and background separately.
3. **Gmail iOS/Android (full inversion, ignores media queries):** the footer logo is a transparent PNG with a cream halo, so it reads on the cream footer and the inverted dark footer. Social icons are opaque discs with a light ring (Gmail never inverts images). The legal text uses the `mix-blend-mode` screen/difference wrapper scoped to `u + .body`, so Gmail can't flip it to unreadable.

4. **iOS auto-links:** `a[x-apple-data-detectors]` reset plus `format-detection` meta, so the address and phone don't turn blue/underlined in dark mode.
5. **Klaviyo compliance stays intact:** `{% unsubscribe_link %}`, `{% manage_preferences_link %}`, `{{ organization.name }}`, `{{ organization.full_address }}`.
6. **Outlook desktop:** VML button and MSO conditionals; the swap logo is hidden with `mso-hide:all`.

Footer module (excerpt)

```
@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) {
  .dm-footer { background-color:#101A14 !important; }
  .dm-muted  { color:#B8B2A4 !important; }  .dm-link { color:#F6F1E7 !important; }
  .logo-default { display:none !important; }  .logo-swap { display:block !important; max-height:none !important; }
}
[data-ogsb] .dm-footer { background-color:#101A14 !important; }  [data-ogsc] .dm-link { color:#F6F1E7 !important; }
u + .body .gm-screen { background:#000; mix-blend-mode:screen; }
u + .body .gm-diff   { background:#000; mix-blend-mode:difference; }

<td class="dm-footer" bgcolor="#E7DFCD" ...>
  <img class="logo-default" src=".../logo-halo.png" ...>
  <!--[if !mso]><!--><img class="logo-swap" src=".../logo-light.png" ...><!--<![endif]-->
  <div class="gm-screen"><div class="gm-diff">
    <a class="dm-link" href="{% manage_preferences_link %}">Manage preferences</a> ·
    <a class="dm-link" href="{% unsubscribe_link %}">Unsubscribe</a>
    {{ organization.name }} · {{ organization.full_address }}
  </div></div>
```

Screenshots are Chromium renders with light/dark color schemes, which reproduce Apple Mail's behaviour. On a real project I verify the footer on device in Gmail iOS/Android, Apple Mail iOS/macOS and Outlook with Litmus / Email on Acid before handoff. The full source (darkmode_footer.klaviyo.html) is attached and ready to paste into a Klaviyo HTML template.

Desktop renders

Same template at 640px. Left: light. Right: dark.

